

SONG JOURNEY

"the cure"

Olivia Rodrigo

Thread song — it appears in all 5 modules

One song, five layers. Each module adds a new skill to this song. Layer 6 is a bonus.

Form	Verse → Chorus → Verse → Chorus → Outro
Verse chords	Am · C · F · C
Chorus chords	Dm · F · C · G/B
Rhythm	One chord per bar. 4 beats each. No capo.
Tempo	Practice at 60 BPM. The record feels like 72 BPM.

LAYER 1 Listen

Module 1

Listen to the song 3 times.

1. Listen for the guitar. It is acoustic and clean.
2. Listen for the chords changing.
3. Listen for how the song gets louder at the end.

Do it: Count the chord changes in one verse. How many different chords do you hear? _____**You've got it when:** You can hum the main hook from memory.**Level up**

Listen one more time. Find the moment the chorus starts.

What changes? _____

LAYER 2 Single Notes

Module 2

Play the root notes of the verse: A · C · F · C. All of them are on the low E string.

Verse root line · low E string · 4 beats per note

	A	C	A	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--

	F	C	F	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--

Play it: 4 beats per note at 60 BPM. Pick each note once per beat.

A = pinky, fret 5 · C = slide up, index on fret 8 · F = index, fret 1

Say each note name out loud.

You've got it when: 2 clean laps at 60 BPM. Your hand moves from fret 8 back to fret 1 without looking.

Level up

Play the same notes on the A string. F stays on the low E.

Level up · A and C on the A string · 4 beats per note

	A	C	F	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--0--0--0--0--	--3--3--3--3--	-----	--3--3--3--3--
E	-----	-----	--1--1--1--1--	-----

LAYER 3 Power Chords**Module 3**

Optional harder challenge. No score.

Play the whole song with one power chord shape moving between two root strings you know. A5, F5, and G5 keep their root on the low E string; C5 and D5 move to the A string, which keeps the whole song inside the first five frets. Play it quietly.

Verse: A5 · C5 · F5 · C5 Chorus: D5 · F5 · C5 · G5

Power chords · roots on the low E and A strings · 4 beats per chord

	A5	C5	F5	C5
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	--5--5--5--5--	-----	--5--5--5--5--
A	--7--7--7--7--	--3--3--3--3--	--3--3--3--3--	--3--3--3--3--
E	--5--5--5--5--	-----	--1--1--1--1--	-----

	D5	F5	C5	G5
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	--7--7--7--7--	-----	--5--5--5--5--	-----
A	--5--5--5--5--	--3--3--3--3--	--3--3--3--3--	--5--5--5--5--
E	-----	--1--1--1--1--	-----	--3--3--3--3--

Play it: 4 beats per chord at 60 BPM. One soft down-strum per beat.

The shape never changes, only which pair of strings it lives on. Move both fingers together when you change chords.

You've got it when: 2 laps, clean and soft. Every change lands on beat 1.

Level up

Play the bassline as single notes. The last note is B, fret 7 — the bass note the record plays under G/B.
Then play one lap loud and one lap very soft.

Level up · bassline as single notes · 4 beats per note

	A	C	F	C
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--5--5--5--5--	--8--8--8--8--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--

	D	F	C	B
e	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	--10 10 10 10--	--1--1--1--1--	--8--8--8--8--	--7--7--7--7--

LAYER 4 Pentatonic Solo

Module 4

Solo with A minor pentatonic. Play softly. Leave space between notes.

Four rungs. Climb them in order.

Rung 1 · Rule of 3**Your three starting notes · A minor pentatonic, Pattern 1**

	A	C	D
e	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----
A	-----5-----	-----	-----
E	--5-----8-----	-----	-----

Play it: Put on the song. Improvise 8 bars with these 3 notes.

Start or end every phrase on A. A is the home note.

You've got it when: Your quietest note is as clean as your loudest.

Rung 2 · The whole box**The whole box · A minor pentatonic Pattern 1 · 5th fret**

e	--5-----8-----
B	--5-----8-----
G	--5-----7-----
D	--5-----7-----
A	--5-----7-----
E	--5-----8-----

Play it: Play the box up and down, softly. Then improvise anywhere inside it.

Rung 3 · Hammer-ons and slides

h = hammer-on. Pick the first note, then tap the higher fret with your ring finger.

/ = slide. Pick once, keep pressing, slide up.

Hammer-ons and slides · all inside Pattern 1

	G	A	C	D	G	A	A
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Play it: Practice each move slowly. The second note must sound clearly. Then add them to your 3-note phrases.

Rung 4 · Two soft licks

Lick 1 · going up · ends on A, let it ring

	E	G	A
e	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----

Lick 2 · going down · ends on A, let it ring

	D	C	A
e	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----

Play it: Learn each lick exactly. Then change one note or change the rhythm.

You've got it when: Your solo uses the box, one hammer-on or slide, and one lick.

Level up

Call and response. Play 2 bars that end away from A. Then play 2 bars that end on A.
Here is one to start with. Then make your own.

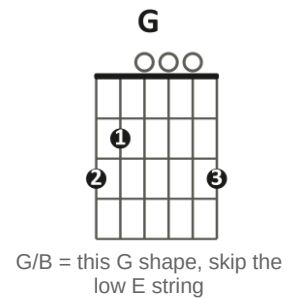
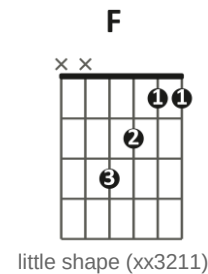
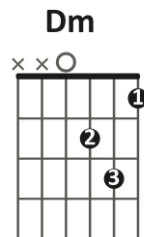
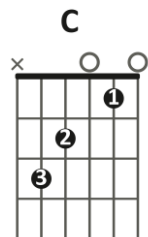
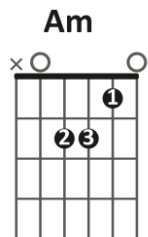
Level up · call and response · 4 bars

	G	A	C	D	D	C	A	G	A	A
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----5-----7-----	-----7-----	-----5-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----5-----7-----	-----	-----7-----5-----7-----	-----7-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

LAYER 5 Open Chords

Module 5

Play the whole song with open chords. One chord per bar. No capo.

**Open chords · 4 beats per chord · 60 → 65 → 70 BPM**

VERSE				CHORUS			
Am	C	F	C	Dm	F	C	G/B
1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4	1 2 3 4

Play it: Down-strums, one per beat. Start at 60 BPM. Then 65. Then 70.

G/B = the G shape without the low E string. The B note is now the bass.

You've got it when: 2 clean loops of the verse and 2 of the chorus at 70 BPM. Every change on beat 1.

Level up

Folk strum on every chord: D D U U D U.

Or play with a partner: you strum, your partner solos Layer 4 over you.

Level up · folk strum · one bar per chord

Am	1 2 & 3 & 4 &	C	1 2 & 3 & 4 &	
D D U U D U	D D U U D U	D D U U D U	D D U U D U	
F	1 2 & 3 & 4 &	C	1 2 & 3 & 4 &	
D D U U D U	D D U U D U	D D U U D U	D D U U D U	

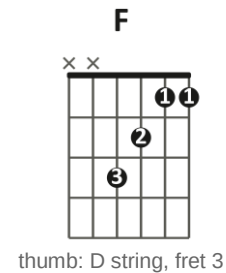
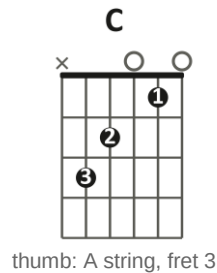
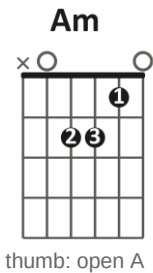
LAYER 6 Fingerpicked Verse

Bonus

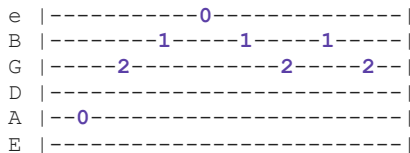
Bonus layer. Optional harder challenge. No score.

No strumming. Pick 8 notes per bar: p i m a m i m i. Two notes per beat.

p = thumb · i = index · m = middle · a = ring. The thumb plays the bass note. The fingers stay on the G, B, and e strings.

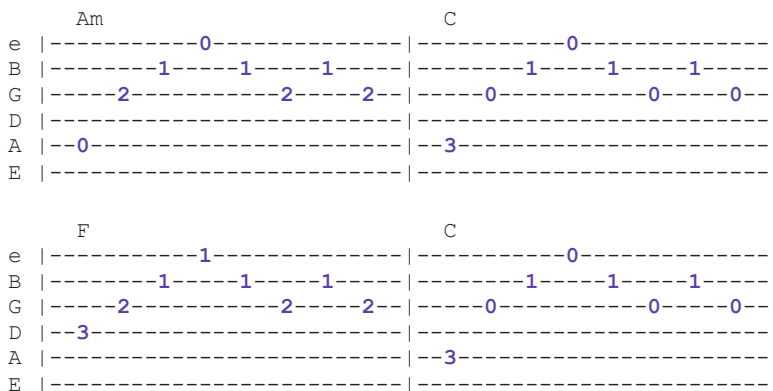


Am · p i m a m i m i · one bar



Play it: One bar of Am at 60 BPM. p = open A · i = G string · m = B string · a = high e string. Then play the whole verse. Only the thumb changes strings.

The verse · one bar per chord · 60 BPM



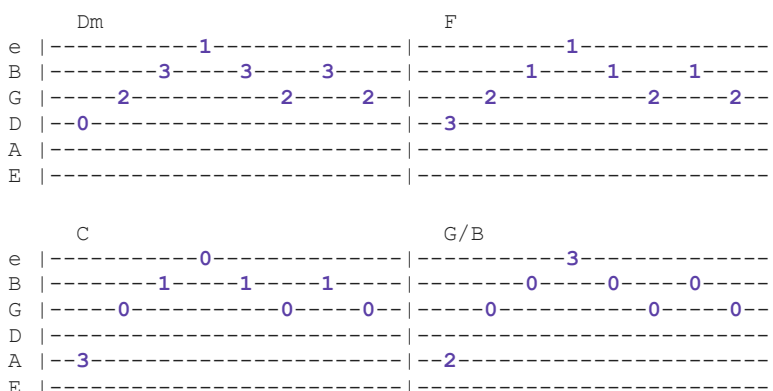
You've got it when: The verse loop Am · C · F · C runs at 60 BPM without stopping.

Level up

Play the chorus the same way: Dm · F · C · G/B.

Thumb: Dm = open D · F = D string, fret 3 · C = A string, fret 3 · G/B = A string, fret 2.

Level up · the chorus · one bar per chord

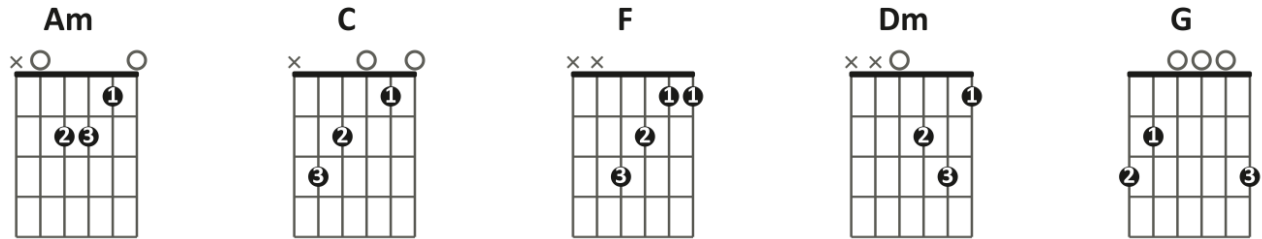


FULL CHORD CHART

"the cure"

Olivia Rodrigo

Key A minor · no capo (capo 1 to match the record)
Tempo Practice at 60 BPM · the record feels like 72 · 4/4
Rhythm One chord per bar · 4 beats each
Form Verse → Chorus → Verse → Chorus → Outro

Shapes you need**VERSE**

	Am		C		F		C	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	----------	--

Soft. Repeat until the chorus.

CHORUS

	Dm		F		C		G/B	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	------------	--

Fuller strumming. G/B = G chord with the B note in the bass.

VERSE

	Am		C		F		C	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	----------	--

Same as the first verse.

CHORUS

	Dm		F		C		G/B	
--	-----------	--	----------	--	----------	--	------------	--

Same as the first chorus.

OUTRO

The ending. Listen to the record and follow it.

Teaching chart — simplified to match the Journey layers. Chord names are what the class plays in standard tuning.

The Cure Chords by Olivia Rodrigo



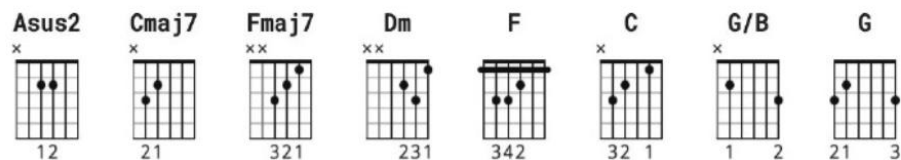
Difficulty: beginner

Tuning: E A D G B E

Capo: 1st fret

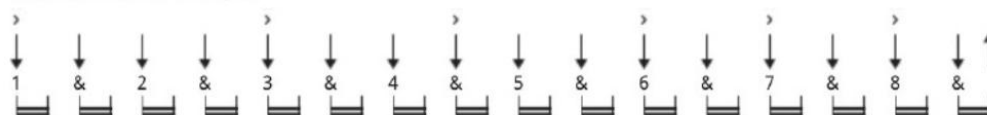
Key: Db

CHORDS



STRUMMING PATTERN

MAIN PATTERN 144 bpm



[Intro]

Asus2 Cmaj7

Asus2 Cmaj7

[Verse 1]

Asus2 Cmaj7

All the pretty girls in the foreground of my mind

Asus2 Cmaj7

I thought I'd done enough, but they keep moving the line

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote this time

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote this time

[Verse 2]

Asus2 Cmaj7

All the nights I spent fighting bad thoughts in my room

Asus2 Cmaj7

Feeling so alone, might as well be on the moon

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote with you

Fmaj7 Cmaj7

I thought I'd found the antidote with you

[Chorus]

Dm **F**
But my head is full of poison, and my heart is full of doubt
C **G/B**
I got toxins in my bloodstream, you tried hard to suck 'em out
Dm **F**
And it feels like medication, and it's good for me, I'm sure
C **G/B**
But it don't matter how your love feels anymore
Dm **F**
It'll never be the cure
C **G/B**
It'll never be the cure

[Verse 3]

Asus2 **Cmaj7**
I used to play a game in my head when I'd date a guy
Asus2 **Cmaj7**
Tally up the girls that he fucked 'til I start to cry
Fmaj7 **Cmaj7**
I thought I'd found the antidote this time
Fmaj7 **Cmaj7**
I thought I'd found the antidote this time

[Refrain]

F
But I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
F
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)

[Chorus]

Dm **F**
And my head is full of poison, and my heart is full of doubt
C **G/B**
I got toxins in my bloodstream, you tried hard to suck 'em out
Dm **F**
And it feels like medication, and it's good for me, I'm sure
C **G/B**
But it don't matter how your love feels anymore
Dm **F**
It'll never be the cure
C **G/B**
It'll never be the cure, oh

[Refrain]

F
'Cause, baby, I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
F
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled)
C **G** **F**
I'm unraveled (I'm unraveled, I'm unraveled)

[Bridge]

C
Why can't you come stitch me up? (I'm unraveled)
G **F**
Why can't it ever be enough? (I'm unraveled)
C
Why can't you come stitch me up? (I'm unraveled)
G **Dm**
Why can't it ever be enough?
F
Ooh-oh
C **G/B**
It's not enough

[Chorus]

Dm **F**
All because my head is full of poison, and my heart is full of doubt (I'm unraveled)
C **G/B**
I got toxins in my bloodstream, you tried so hard to suck out (I'm unraveled)
Dm **F**
And it feels like medication, and it's good for me, I'm sure (I'm unraveled)
C **G/B**
But it don't matter how your love feels anymore (I'm unraveled)
Dm **F**
It'll never be the cure
C **G/B**
It will never be the cure

It'll never be

[Outro]

Dm F C G/B
Dm F C G/B